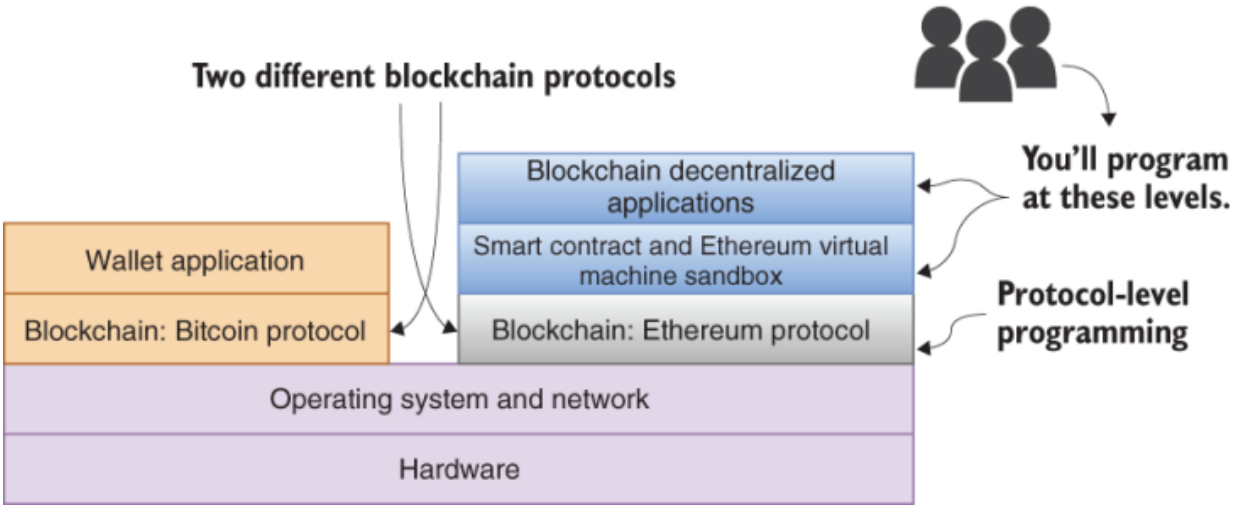


Figure 1.10 Bitcoin versus Ethereum protocol stacks

Currently, many blockchains (such as EOS, ZCash, and IOTA) exist, with different protocols, and the expectation is that they will consolidate to a few eventually. The goal of this chapter is to give you a general idea of the various features of blockchain, independent of any particular technology. This high-level knowledge will help you be a better blockchain designer and developer. You'll follow the Ethereum blockchain protocol for programming smart contracts and Dapps in chapters 2-11.

1.3.4 Trust enabler

Trust is critical for business and personal transactions, whether those transactions are trade, commerce, legal, medical, marital, interpersonal, or financial. Imagine a business transaction for transferring a million dollars. You have a secure channel for transfer, but are you sure you can trust the parties involved? You typically use an intermediary such as a bank to establish the credentials of the transacting